

square as Black has c6 so well defended. Better was 18 Qe2 Bh6 19 Nf3 Nh5 20 g3 Rab8 21 Ra1 f5 with a very double-edged game.

18...Bh6! 19 Na5 Rc7 20 Be2

White admits the failure of his opening strategy. He plans to defend his knight with Qd3 but Black now has a strong exchange sacrifice.

20...Rxc3! 21 Bxc3 Nxe4 22 Be1 Rc8 23 Bf3 Nf6 24 Bd2 Bxd2 25 Qxd2 e4 26 Be2 Nxd5 (Diagram 20)

With two strong pawns for the exchange the black position is better.

27 Rb3 Be6 28 Rc1 Rxc1+ 29 Qxc1 e3! 30 fxe3 Nf4 31 Rb2

Forced as Black was threatening both 31...Nxe2+ and 31...Bxb3.

31...N6d5 32 Bf1

White could have tried to hold the e-pawn with 32 Kf2 but then 32...Nxe2! 33 Kxg2 Nxe3+ gives Black a crushing attack.

32...Nxe3 33 Kh1 Qd4 34 Nb3? Qe5 35 Na5 Nxf1 36 Nc6 Ng3+ 37 hxxg3 Qh5+ 38 Kg1 Ne2+ 39 Rxe2 Qxe2 40 Nd4 Qe4 41 Qd2 Bc4 42 Kh2 Qd3 White resigns

Game 28

□ Ljubojevic ■ Kasparov

Linares 1993

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Be2 0-0 6 Nf3 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 Nd2 a5 10 Rb1 Nd7 11 a3 f5 12 b4 Kh8 13 f3 f4 14 Nb3?!

This is a rather feeble way of preparing c4-c5 as the knight will be passively placed once c4-c5 has been achieved. Remember this knight was supposed to go to the aggressive c4-square. Let's take a look at some of the alternatives.

1) In the late 1980's and early 1990's there were quite a few games that went 14 c5 axb4 15 axb4 dxc5 16 bxc5 Nxc5 17 Nc4. The open lines on the queenside gave White good compensation for the pawn. Black then made the important discovery that he should refrain from the exchange on b4. For example, after 14...dxc5 15 bxc5 Nxc5 Black can meet 16 Nc4 with 16...a4 when it is not easy for White to generate threats.

2) 14 Na4 is a crude way to support c4-c5 and Dr. Nunn believes that this decentralising move is best met by 14...axb4 15 axb4 c6.

3) 14 Qc2 also prepares the advance c4-c5 by making the pawn sacrifice to dangerous to accept. Black can try and hold it up with 14...b6 but he can also get on with his kingside attack, e.g. 14...g5 15 c5 axb4 16 axb4 Nf6 17 Nc4 h5 with a double-edged game.

14...axb4 15 axb4 g5 16 Bd2?

White opts for the leisurely plan of invading down the a-file. It is too slow. Kasparov believes the only chance is to block it up with 16 g4.

16...Ng6 17 Ra1 Rxa1 18 Qxa1 Nf6 19 Qa7

Now it's too late to block the kingside as after 19 g4 fxg3 20 hxxg3 Nh5

21 Kg2 Ngf4+! 22 gxf4 gxf4 Black has a crushing attack.

19...g4 (Diagram 21)

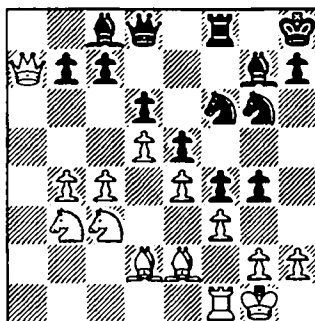


Diagram 21

Black's attack is much faster

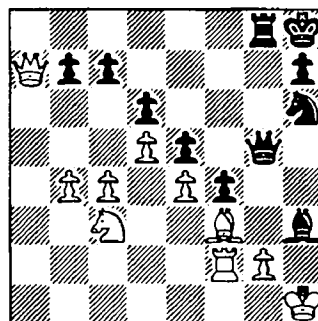


Diagram 22

The thematic capture is decisive

20 fxg4 Nxf4 21 h3

White could have tried 21 Bxf4 Bxf4 though after 22 Qxb7 Nh4 Black's attack is decisive according to Kasparov.

21...Nh6 22 Be1 Rg8 23 Nd2 Bf6!

Clearing the g-file and preparing to play ...Bh4. Once dark-squared bishops are exchanged it will be easy for Black on the kingside.

24 Kh1 Bh4 25 Nf3 Bxe1 26 Nxe1

After 26 Rxe1 Nh4 27 Rg1 Nxf3 28 Bxf3 Qh4 the game will also be decided by Black sacrificing his bishop on h3.

26...Nh4 27 Rf2 Qg5 28 Nf3 Nxf3 29 Bxf3 Bxh3 (Diagram 22)

White resigns

A possible finish is 30 Qxb7 Bxf2+ 31 Rxf2 Qh4+ 32 Kg1 Qe1+ 33 Kh2 Rxf2+ 34 Bxf2 Qg3+ 35 Kh1 f3 36 Qc8+ Ng8 and wins.

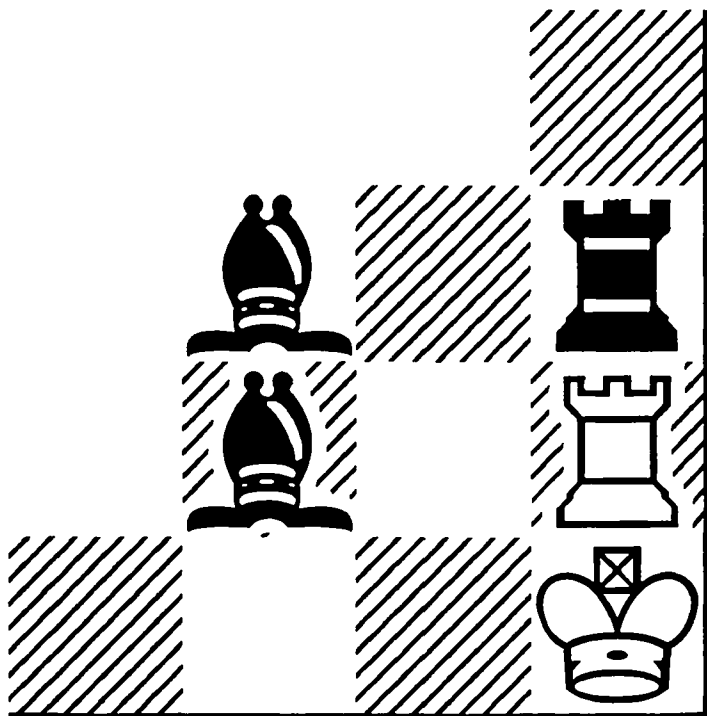
Summary

- 1) This chapter contains the two variations that have dominated King's Indian theory over the last decade or so.
- 2) In the 10 Re1 line of the Bayonet Attack, Black should not consider 9...Nh5 as the first step on a journey to f4, but as a means of preparing ...f7-f5. It is still better to play 9...Nh5 than 9...Ne8 or 9...Nd7 as White is encouraged to waste a tempo with 10 Re1 or to weaken his kingside with 10 g3.
- 3) Black should not be overambitious. Equality is a good result.
- 4) Against 9 Nd2 Black should reply 9...a5!. This slows down White's queenside play and doesn't relinquish any of Black's attacking ideas.

Chapter Five

The Sämisch Variation

- **Black Sacrifices a Pawn with 6...c5**
- **The Panno: 6...Nc6**
- **The Traditional 6...e5**
- **White Plays 6 Bg5 (or 6 Nge2)**



1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 f3 (Diagram 1)

Look at the following list of names: Botvinnik, Tal, Petrosian, Spassky, Karpov, Kasparov, Kramnik. What do they have in common? Yes, they are all post war World Champions and yes, they are amongst the greatest players ever to hail from the USSR (Russia). The other thing they have in common is that they have all played the Sämisch! Many more names can be added to the list (Korchnoi, Shirov etc), so it is clear that the Sämisch is a high class variation which needs to be treated with respect. Having said that, its popularity is no longer what it used to be. I see it as the Grand Hotel of the King's Indian – an imperial variation that is slightly over the hill. That is not meant to be cruel to the Sämisch, as I play it myself quite often, but it has clearly slipped a long way behind the Classical in the King's Indian popularity stakes. It is currently vying for second place along with the Fianchetto variation.

The Sämisch owes its name to the German Grandmaster Fritz Sämisch. He is also famous for a line in the Nimzo-Indian – 1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 e6 3 Nc3 Bb4 4 a3 – where White also constructs a big centre supported by f3.

What are the ideas behind the move 5 f3?

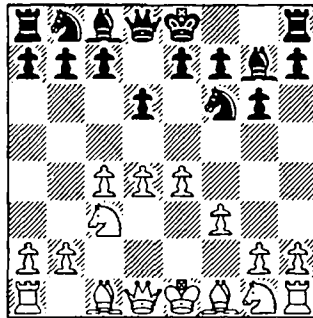


Diagram 1
The ever-popular Sämisch

- 1) It defends e4 so creates a secure and stable centre.
 - 2) With his centre so stable White can start an attack on the kingside. Be3, Qd2, Bh6, g2-g4 and h2-h4 are typical moves when White wishes to carry out this plan. On other occasions White may attack on the queenside. The Sämisch is a flexible variation which does not commit White to any particular course of action.
 - 3) The move f2-f3 secures the square e3 for White's bishop. It can now take up residence there without having to worry about ...Ng4.
- The move f2-f3 also has certain drawbacks. 'Ask the knight on g1

what he thinks of the move f3' was a famous comment from the Ukrainian Grandmaster and raconteur Eduard Gufeld. In return for having such a strong centre White accepts that his kingside development is going to be rather clumsy.

What are the main ways to combat the Sämisch?

Black has three distinct strategies.

1) Black can strike in the centre in Benoni fashion with ...c7-c5. Over the last decade or so this has supplanted all other variations and become the main line of the Sämisch. This is the subject of Section 1.



NOTE: The Benoni is a sister variation of the King's Indian which normally starts 1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 c5 3 d5 e6 4 Nc3 exd5 5 cxd5 d6 6 e4 g6 followed by ...Bg7. Variations in the King's Indian where Black plays ...c7-c5 and White replies d4-d5 lead to a similar structure.

2) He can delay his central strike in favour of queenside play. The most common way to do this is to play 6 ...Nc6, 7 ...a6 and 8 ...Rb8 so that Black can play ...b7-b5 at a moment's notice. This is called the Panno Variation and is the subject of the second section.

3) He can strike in the centre with the traditional King's Indian move ...e7-e5. This is the subject of the third sub-section.

The above variations all assume that White plays 6 Be3. In our fourth section we shall take a look at the alternative 6th moves for White, principally 6 Bg5.

Black Sacrifices a Pawn with 6...c5

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 f3 0-0 6 Be3 c5 (Diagram 2)

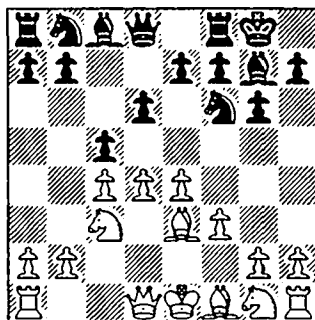


Diagram 2
A pawn sacrifice

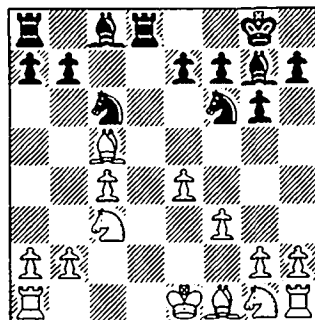


Diagram 3
The g7-bishop is looking good

It has long been understood that playing ...c7-c5 is one of the most desirable ways for Black to meet the Sämisch. It keeps the long diagonal